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# Dr Michio Kaku: Philippines poised to leap into the future

The noted theoretical physicist, author, TV host, and pop icon of science says the Philippines has to focus on building two things: education and entrepreneurship

**Peter Imbong**  
Published 2:47 PM, December 31, 2013  
Updated 2:48 PM, December 31, 2013

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MICHIO KAKU. According to the noted futurist, theoretical physicist, author, TV host, and pop icon of science, the Philippines is poised to leap into the future. All photo from Peter Imbong

MANILA, Philippines – Many simply know him as the silver-haired Asian scientist on TV who talks about the history of the universe, the existence of the fourth dimension, and life on other planets, among many other things.

But for his millions of fans around the world – geeks and nerds, mostly, as well as colleagues in the scientific community – futurist, theoretical physicist, author, and radio and TV host Michio Kaku is a pop culture icon.

His PhD in physics from the University of California at Berkeley aside – as well as his more than 30 years as a professor and author of several best-selling books – it is, perhaps, his stint on TV, bringing the distant and inaccessible topic of physics and the universe down to the common man, that's made the Harvard-educated Kaku one of the most recognizable figures in science.

Kaku was one of two guest speakers at the First Pacific Leadership Academy Executive Series held in November at the SMX Convention Center in SM Aura Premiere. The US-born scientist spoke on the topic of business innovation, and took questions from the audience.

**The future of the Philippines**

"I think the Philippines is poised to leap into the future by not repeating the same mistakes of the West," said Kaku when asked about the country's role in the future. Citing the aspect of infrastructure, he points out: "In the West we have an ageing infrastructure. We have a subway system that's more than a hundred years old, bridges that are rusting and falling apart, and roads that are crumbling."

In the developing world, however, "you can start fresh with the very latest in subway and transportation technology," He added: "Instead of wiring your cities, you can go wireless and leap ahead in terms of telecommunication with satellites and microwave towers."

"We also had the big [real estate] crash of 2008. Many countries did not have a real estate bubble, and therefore they didn't suffer as much as those countries that did." But, he pointed out, the priorities of the government should be on two things.

**Education and entrepreneurship**

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